MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1868

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor

SAVE THE OLD ADOBE

The February Meeting

A few years ago we visited with my wife's relatives in Norway. I was struck by the fact that "the new house" was one built before our Civil War, and "the old house" was still in use on one side of the farm quadrangle of buildings. When we lived in New York, the James Fenimore Cooper house was still being lived in, and pre-revolutionary war homes were not unusual.

Here in the west there is very little left from even a few decades ago. The buildings have been replaced with structures of little distinction, the meadows and fields paved over, and the farmlands planted to housing developments. Our oldest buildings in Mountain View are a handful in downtown which survived the earthquake.

Roots and ties to the past are what builds a sense of belonging and community, and with this sense comes manners and a regard for each other. The facts are that few of us have been here more than a generation, almost none more than two generations. We need some way to tie ourselves back to the past. Not a past of father, grand- father, great-grandfather, but perhaps a past of previous

*(see - **Old Adobe** - on page 2)*

THE PEACE CORPS IN HUNGARY

The November Meeting

The Mountain View Historical Association held its November, 1995 meeting on 11/05/95 at the Senior Center. A sizeable audience of members and friends heard our President, Ralph Faravelli kick off the "Save The Adobe" campaign (of which more elsewhere in this Newsletter). This was followed by Trudi Herrero Odbert describing her experiences as a Peace Corps Volunteer in Hungary.

Trudi is almost a native of Mountain View, having moved here with her parents as a youngster. She grew up in Mountain View, attended local schools, and married a Navy Man from Moffett Field. Navy life took them all over the world, but at retirement they returned to Mountain View, where Trudi obtained a Masters in Education from Stanford and then taught in a local high school. After retiring from teaching, she was inspired by a granddaughter to apply for the Peace Corps, and was accepted.

As a Peace Corps volunteer, she spent two years as a teacher at the University at Veszprem, Hungary, teaching Linguistics, American Culture,

*(see - **Peace Corps** - on page 2)*

*(from - **Peace Corps** - on page 1)*

Cross Cultural Conversations and Literature. It was a somewhat lonely assignment since she did not become truly fluent in Hungarian, but she did establish many close ties. A long term project is to establish Vesprem as a "Sister City" with Mountain View.

The adjustment in coming home was more difficult than the adjustment in going over. The Hungarians place great emphasis on family, and they took her into a small University oriented town.

Trudi is already becoming re-engaged in Mountain View, picking up issues and causes, and with her family. We're glad she's back, and we're grateful for the time she spent telling us of her experiences in the Peace Corps.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING
December 14, 1995

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met at 10:00 AM on Thursday, December 14, 1995 in the Pioneer Room. The Treasurer's Report and Membership Report are provided elsewhere in this Newsletter. The picnic area at Cuesta Park will be reserved for the Third Annual Barbecue and Social for a Sunday in August of 1996. Reburial of the remains disturbed in the Cumberland Cemetery caused by Library construction is proceeding. Participation in the Art and Wine Festival for 1996 will be explored.

Most of the meeting was given over to planning and organizing for the Save The Adobe project. "Save The Adobe" will be the subject of the February, 1996 meeting, and the topic is discussed elsewhere in this Newsletter.

*(see - **Exec Com** - next column)*

*(from - **Old Adobe** - on page 1)*

generation, grand-generation and great-grand-generation. If we can do that, it gives all of us roots amongst all of the peoples who have lived here over the last few centuries.

How can we do this? Buildings like the Old Adobe can be a start. The building was erected at an economic turning point for the area. The old skills of working with adobe bricks were dying out. The Spanish/Mexican heritage was being overrun by immigrants from the American East and Midwest. So, while the Old Adobe is not an old building by the standards of other areas, in style and feel it is a structure from our past. It is worth preserving simply as an architectural link with the past.

There are other reasons for preserving the structure. We're short on good meeting space in Mountain View. Convenient space for club meetings, a bridge tournament, a small convention, a charitable group meeting are all in short supply. A historic role for the Old Adobe might be a revival of teen dances on Friday evenings.

We don't yet have a firm handle on what it might cost to restore the Old Adobe to serviceable condition, or what the feasible uses for the building might be. We don't know where the money required might come from, or how the facility would be managed when restoration is complete. We need a strong expression of support from the public for restoring the Old Adobe. We'll take a long step on that road at the Mountain View Historical Association meeting on Sunday, February 4, 1996. Come to the meeting with your thoughts and ideas and lets see what we can and should do.

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*(from - **Exec Com** - in previous column)*

The complete minutes of the meetings of the Executive Committee are available to any member of the Association from either the Secretary or Newsletter Editor.

JOSEPH F. KENNEDY

By Shirley Pearson and Kathleen Lowe Owen

Many of us have ancestors who came west in the middle of the 19th century. The Pioneer Room has a copy of the diary of one such intrepid traveler - Joseph Finley Kennedy. Kennedy kept a diary of this trip to California in 1863. The diary began two days before he actually left and discussed both the hardships and joys experienced along the way. For example, on June 9, 1863 Joseph wrote "passed several graves today and hardly a day passes but what our attention is arrested by one or two of these solitary mounds. The end of many a poor emigrant's journey." To read more of his diary you can visit the Pioneer Room on the fourth floor of City Hall on Tues., Wed., and Thurs. from 1-5 PM.

Kennedy was born in Independence, Missouri in 1843. He left his family's home in Council Bluffs, Iowa by wagon train on May 19th, 1863, and finished his journey on the afternoon of September 3rd, 1863 in Dublin, California. Joseph tried several occupations before becoming a school teacher in Pleasanton.

On January 21, 1868, Kennedy married Sarah Margaret Graham of Mountain View. She was the third child of Isaac Newton Graham after whom Graham Middle School is named. The young couple's first child, James Isaac, was born in Pleasanton at the end of 1868 and their second, Frances Winifred, in Mountain View in 1870. They were living in Alvarado, CA, for the birth of their third child Margaret Elizabeth, in March, 1871.

Sarah died of consumption on April 5, 1871, and Joseph brought the children back to Mountain View, where the baby was raised by her maternal grandparents, Isaac and Elizabeth Graham. The two older children went to live with their mother's aunt, Mrs. Winfred Mayers, and her husband, also of Mountain View.

*(see - **Kennedy** - in next column)*

THE EDITOR'S RAMBLINGS

By Hilton Brown

The article on Joseph F. Kennedy in this Newsletter indicates that his wife Sarah died of consumption. Consumption is another term for phthisis or tuberculosis, and this disease accounts for one quarter of the known causes of death of the persons interred in Pioneer Cemetery in the last century. Almost another quarter died of pneumonia, bronchitis or typhoid.

I'm not sure what to make of this, except to comment upon the amazing strides we have made in dealing with illness, and how poorly we have done in dealing with violence. The young woman, Sarah Kennedy, probably weakened by the stress of her pregnancy, died of tuberculosis within a month of the birth of her third child.

The Weilheimer daughter mentioned in 100 Years Ago, is the scion of the building located at 124-126 Castro Street, possibly the oldest building in Mountain View.

Help! Volunteers are needed at the Senior Center on February 4, 1996, at 1:15 p.m. to help arrange furniture for our meeting. Anyone willing to help us place 4 tables and 100 chairs, please call Edna Thompson at 967-3116. Gratefully,

Edna, Chuck and Helen. ***Help!***

*(from - **Kennedy** - in previous column)*

Joseph moved to Spokane, Washington while his children remained in Mountain View. Their daughter Margaret Elizabeth joined him later and married and raised her family there.

Joseph's son, James worked as Deputy County Clerk of South Santa Clara County for 9 1/2 years, and then was Post Master of Mountain View from 1915 to 1921. Joseph's granddaughter, Bernice Murphy married Fred Jarvis, former Police Chief of Mountain View.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
Noted by Barbara Kinchen

100 YEARS AGO (1896): Miss Rose South was appointed Postmistress, replacing Dennis J. Murphy, who recently resigned as Postmaster.

The new Weilheimer daughter had one tooth when born.

Mountain View ranks 4th in tonnage shipped by Southern Pacific Company, in the division stretching between San Francisco and San Luis Obispo, surpassed only by San Francisco, San Jose and Gilroy. More wine is shipped from here than from any other point in Santa Clara County.

The Washington Day Celebration included a parade, with school children and a brass band, followed by a program in Olympic Hall which included the reading of Washington's Farewell Address by Henry Rengstorff.

Over 350 guests attended Mountain View Cyclers minstrel and vaudeville entertainment, supper and grand ball. Dancing went on until 4 a.m.

Newly organized: Eastern Star chapter, Companions of the Forest (Ladies branch of Foresters of America) and Independent Cyclers.

75 YEARS AGO(1921): Many motored to Mt. Hamilton to see and play in the snow which is almost three feet deep.

Mountain View now has two theaters - Campen's Glen Theatre with its recently installed Wurlitzer organ and the new People's Theatre, temporarily located in the Women's Club building. Opening night featured 'The Beast", a high-class western drama featuring George Walsh, along with a comedy entitled "Roaring Lions on the Midnight Express."

"A loafer always thinks he is a misguided genius."

Council adopted an ordinance prohibiting minors under 16 from being alone on the streets after 8 p.m. They must be accompanied by a parent, guardian or someone over age 21 and appointed by parent or guardian.

Herman Berta, local plumber, advertises as "Your Pipe Doctor."

Because of the small pox epidemic, parents are urged to have children vaccinated.

50 YEARS AGO (1946): Police Chief A.H. Excell requested a new police car - "one that won't have to be towed to start it and, which after being started does something more than make a noise."

Saturday mornings Mountain View Theatre showed 14 cartoons for the kiddies. The 25¢ admission included popcorn.

Tire rationing ended.

The Order of the Purple Heart and Silver Star for gallantry in action were awarded Harry Pinto at Moffett Field ceremonies.

Citizens of Italian extraction have organized as Sunnyview Family Club and plan to build a clubhouse on a lot to rear of Shopke & Burke Lumber, near El Camino and El Monte.

Set aside during the war years, the ordinance banning poultry, rabbits, goats, cows, etc. within city limits, was again enforced. Citizens were thanked for raising meat for their own families, thereby making more available for servicemen, but were asked to "cheerfully cooperate" by removing their animals.

25 YEARS AGO (1971): A 10-acre parcel at Grant Road and Phyllis Avenue was approved for a shopping center and Handyman store.

The 49th Annual Citizen of the Year went to Austin Spencer, assistant manager at United California Bank. Born and raised in Mountain View, Spencer was honored by the Chamber of Commerce for his many civic activities.

*(see - **Old News Items** - on page 5)*

(from - Old News Items - on page 4)

In the All American Cities competition sponsored by National Municipal League and Look Magazine, Mountain View Received honorable mention for providing low and moderately priced housing and for finding homes for families displaced with the widening of Bailey Avenue.

NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM

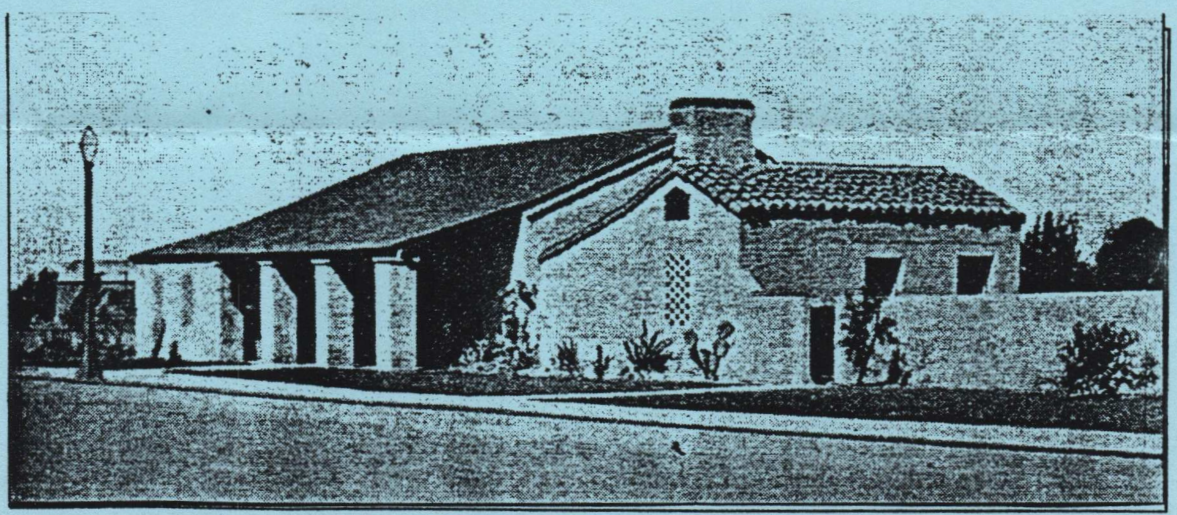
Reported by Barbara Kinchen

From Mrs. Helen Newfarmer Remington - Painting of the Adobe Building by her late husband, Ormand Newfarmer.

From Bernice Wikstrom - 8" by 45" photo of Highway Grammar School pupils and teachers, circa 1928.

From Donald Lawson - A book titled "The Mercantile Agency Reference Book With a List of Banks and Bankers." Published Jan. 1923 by R.G. Dun and Co. Has interesting information about some Mountain View merchants and bankers.

From Eva Mockbee - Red and white felt 'MV' and red and white felt basketball player, mementoes from when Eva's husband Bud, coached a local Japanese basketball team.



The Old Adobe Building in its prime.

SAVE THE ADOBE COMMITTEE

By Wally Erichsen and Hilton Brown

The President and Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association have determined that efforts to preserve the ***"Old Adobe Building"*** fall well within the Aims of the Association as spelled out in the By-Laws. The President and Executive Committee have therefore commissioned a Committee, to be Chaired by Wallace J. Erichsen, to develop and oversee a strategy to Save the ***Old Adobe Building***. The Committee held its first meeting on Thursday January 11, 1996.

This first meeting was devoted to organizational matters, identification of resources, identification of requirements, identification of information sources and formulation of a strategy and plan of action.

Resources already identified and available include the following:

THE ADOBE BUILDING, Carol Fischer, in the October, 1994 Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

SAVE THE ADOBE CAMPAIGN BEGINS, Eva G. Mockbee, in the November, 1995 MVHA Newsletter

LOCAL HISTORICAL GROUP CAMPAIGNS TO SAVE OLD ADOBE, Rufus Jeffris, Mountain View Voice, Vol 3, No. 18

STUDY SESSION ON SEPTEMBER 19, 1995 - ADOBE BUILDING, Ellis M. Berns, City of Mountain View Memorandum

A video tape, KMVT CITY VIEW, Host Ben DeBolt, December

The Pioneer Room has some material relating to the Old Adobe.

The plan of action established at the January meeting includes a parallel effort to develop an ordinance for preservation of historic buildings along with a study of the potential uses for a renovated Adobe building.

The February 4, 1996 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will address the issue ***"Save The Adobe"***. A panel of speakers will bring back memories of the early use of the building as well as discuss potential future uses. Panel members will be:

Arthur Walton	Moderator
Ellis Berns	
Hilton Brown	
Ralph Faravelli	
Peggy Mylrea Matthews	
Eva Mockbee	
Betty Erichsen Stoddard	

"SAVE THE ADOBE" Committee members are:

Wally Erichsen	Chair
Ellis Berns	
Hilton Brown	
Ben DeBolt	
Ralph Faravelli	
Liesa Fulton	
Tim Johnson	
Barbara Kinchen	
Eva Mockbee	
Trudy Herrero Odbert	
Bob Schatz	
Honor Spitz	
Astrid Thompson	
Edna Thompson	
Kassandra Winder	

It will require a significant community effort to ***"Save The Adobe"***. If you would like to get involved, come to the February MVHA meeting, or contact any member of the committee to find out where you can fit in.

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

As of January 10, 1996

Reported by Edna Thompson

A list of all members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available from the Chair of the Membership Committee or from the Newsletter Editor.

Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $ 10.00 per year for a family and Life Membership is $ 100.00 per person.

Below is a tally by class of membership, and list of the new members.

Life Members		32
Honored Member		1
Special Members		3
Family Memberships		50
Individual Members		115
Discontinued	4	
New	2	
Total Memberships		201
Total Members		251

New Members (Since the last Newsletter)

Melba Williams
Betty E. McLaren
Louis and Wanda Beck (Family)
Norene Hogle (Life Member)

Life Members

(Those marked * are new life members in 1996)

Lorena Anderson
Dena K. Bonnell
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle*
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
John W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Bill Wissell

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD

President	Ralph Faravelli
Vice President & Program	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June DeLarios
Past President	Wally Erichsen
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Publicity	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorials/Rememberances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Albert Jehning
Social Activities	Wally Erichsen

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics, submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

TREASURER'S REPORT

September 1995 - December 1995

As Reported by June de Larios

Balance 9/1/95		$ 6,121.41
Income:		
Dues	41.00	
Sales (Notepaper Stationery, Cards)	318.50	
Total		359.50
Expenses:		
Administration	153.69	
Newsletter	347.81	
Remembrance	60.34	
Video	110.00	
Total		671.84
*Balance 12/31/95		$ 5,809.07

** Balance includes $3,200.00 in dues paid by Life Members, a continuing obligation for the Association*

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Regular Meeting

Sunday, February 4, 1996 - 2:00 PM

Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speakers

Save The Adobe

A Panel Presentation

led by

Arthur Walton

What? ***Why?*** ***When?***
Who? ***How?***

MEMBERSHIP

Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS The aims of this Association are: To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places. To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

_____

TELEPHONE _____

NEW ___ RENEWAL ___ Regular Membership $7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr - Life Membership $100.00
Make Check Payable and mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

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Dues are now payable for 1996.

An addressed envelope is enclosed for your payment. Dues are $ 7.00 for an individual for one year or $ 10.00 for a family for one year or one payment of $ 100.00 for an individual for a Life Membership. If our records show that your dues have been paid you will not receive an envelope. Any questions please call Edna Thompson at (415) 967-3116. Thank you.